

Photographs by CHANDRADEEP KUMAR and ARABINDA MAHAPATRA

THE BEST DISTRICTS OF ODISHA 2022

CATEGORY	BEST PERFORMING DISTRICT	MOST IMPROVED DISTRICT
OVERALL	SAMBALPUR	KORAPUT
ECONOMY	KHORDHA	MAYURBHANJ
INFRASTRUCTURE	JHARSUGUDA	BARGARH
AGRICULTURE	BARGARH	KORAPUT
EDUCATION	KHORDHA	BALANGIR
HEALTH	SAMBALPUR	NABARANGPUR
LAW AND ORDER	GANJAM	KENDUJHAR
SOCIAL SECURITY	RAYAGADA	JAGATSINGHPUR
WOMEN'S EDUCATION	BHADRAK	MALKANGIRI
ENTREPRENEURSHIP	JHARSUGUDA	JAGATSINGHPUR
SKILL DEVELOPMENT	KHORDHA	SUNDARGARH
DIGITAL COVERAGE	SAMBALPUR	KORAPUT
SANITATION	KHORDHA	KALAHANDI

tions of the people who had reposed faith in him, so he took up the daunting task with a single-minded focus and determination. The rest is history. After two decades at the helm, Patnaik's winning streak has only gotten better, leaving political opponents in the dust. The reasons for success are simple, he says: people-centric governance made to function on the principles of the five Ts—transparency, team work, timeliness, technology and transformation. India Today's Odisha State of the State 2022 report, prepared in association with premier market research organisation Marketing and Development Research Associates (MDRA), was a vindication of this transformative story.

On April 29, at the India Today State of the State Conclave Odisha 2022 held in Bhubaneswar, Group Editorial Director Raj Chengappa hailed Patnaik as "the calm who helped maintain the cosmos amid the chaos". He was referring to a time from the early noughties when Odisha's chaotic financial situation was made worse by the natural calamities that kept battering the state. "Odisha's unique hands-on approach model to disaster management and purpose-driven approach in terms of social welfare and governance with the 5-T style of management helped script the turnaround," Chengappa added.

"The reasons for our success are simple, people-centric governance focusing on the five Ts—team work, transparency, technology, timeliness, transformation"

NAVEEN PATNAIK
Odisha chief minister



The best districts awards distributed at the conclave were calculated based on the key aspects that affect the lives of citizens and the development of the districts, with their performance evaluated in 12 key categories—overall, economy, infrastructure, agriculture, education, health, law and order, social security, women's education, entrepreneurship, skill development, digital coverage and sanitation. An extensive review of MDRA's database and potential sources of reliable data was conducted by an experienced team of researchers, sociologists, economists and statisticians. A total of 112 indicators were considered to evaluate the best performing districts